CHAPTER 3

Fine-Tuning Our Rails Image

We covered a lot of ground in the previous chapter. We saw our first Dockerfile, which we used to build a custom image, tailored for running our Rails app.

However, you may recall that we said this Dockerfile was "good enough" but "not perfect" (Defining Our First Custom Image, on page 18). The truth is, we took a few shortcuts for the sake of simplicity. Now that you have some Docker fundamentals under your belt, we can go back and address these issues.

By the end of this chapter, we'll have our Dockerfile looking shipshape and ready for us to dive into the final piece of the development puzzle—Docker Compose—but I'm getting ahead of myself.

So grab some overalls, a trusty wrench, and plenty of spit and polish—you're going to need them, metaphorically speaking that is.

Naming and Versioning Our Image

When we ran our Rails server with this command:

```
$ docker run -p 3000:3000 a1df0eddba18 \
    bin/rails s -b 0.0.0.0
```

we referred to our custom image by its ID: a1df0eddba18 (yours will differ). There's no way we're going to remember that. Just like you wouldn't refer to a Git branch using the SHA-1 hash of its latest commit, the same is true for images. Instead, we give our images human-friendly names by *tagging* them. Let's say we want to name our image railsapp. We can do this by running:

```
$ docker tag a1df0eddba18 railsapp
```

which says, "Tag the image identified by 'a1df0eddba18' with 'railsapp'." To verify this worked, let's list our images with:

```
$ docker images
```